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Dear Hiring Manager,

The disputes paralegal role at the boutique firm you are recruiting for is the kind of position my experience has been building toward. My year at BCLP, combined with my LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution and ongoing advisory work at Citizens Advice, gives me practical grounding in exactly the work the role covers: legal research, document management, drafting and reviewing legal documents across complex, high-value matters.

At BCLP's international arbitration team, I supported a complex investment arbitration from evidence review through to submission of the Claimant's memorial. I reviewed and organised large volumes of documents for procedural submissions, amended sections of the memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator. Shortly before a significant deadline, I became the only junior supporting the team, which meant tracking all outstanding actions and coordinating documents across the matter myself. The partner and associate both gave feedback that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. That experience gave me a clear sense of what high-pressure, document-heavy disputes work actually requires, and I found I was well suited to it.

In the real estate disputes rotation, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials, and conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes. Managing document volumes across several competing matters at once, while keeping matter records current in iManage, sharpened the file management skills that are central to the role you are describing.

My current work at Citizens Advice adds a different dimension. I take detailed factual statements from clients, establish chronologies, identify evidential gaps and draft correspondence and applications under real deadlines. Working with clients on sensitive matters, often involving complex procedural rules, has strengthened both my client communication and my ability to translate complicated legal positions into clear, practical terms.

The firm's focus on civil fraud, financial services disputes, insolvency and asset recovery, including matters with an international element, maps closely onto the areas I have studied and worked in. My LLM dissertation addressed cross-jurisdictional data protection, and the arbitration and disputes events I have attended outside formal study, including London International Disputes Week and a King's College London session on abuse of process in international arbitration, reflect a sustained interest in the field rather than a general one.

I would be glad to discuss how my background fits the team's current needs.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva